

Capacity Becomes Strategy — Strategic Intelligence Report — Belastingdienst — April 2026

Strategic Intelligence Report · Belastingdienst

Capacity Becomes Strategy

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Board Snapshot — Belastingdienst · April 2026

Themes: Trust recovery as binding constraint · AI in the tax landscape · Cross-border fiscal harmonisation · Embedded / seamless / hyper-personalised tax meets the Jetten reform window

Top 3 Board-Critical Risks

- **Capacity is the binding constraint on every other theme this cycle.** The Belastingdienst's IT estate is [19.3% legacy](#); modernisation is projected to be largely complete by end-2026 with some chains continuing into 2027; the staatssecretaris confirms in the [Jaarplan 2026](#) that "deel ICT-systemen kan vanaf 2026 nieuw beleid aan". At the same moment the Jetten coalition wants a fundamental reform of income tax, toeslagen and social security, Box 3 transition lands 1 January 2028, ViDA implementation begins, DAC8 is live, and the AI-defence stack must be rebuilt — capacity was just becoming free, and four queues now form at the same door. Decide Tier-1 Belastingdienst Jaarplan and IT-estate disclosure; Tier-2 sell-side tax-plan analyses. Directionally consistent across all sources.
- **The [PHFFA-style](#) regulatory pressure on AI use, plus the [March 2026 AP Rapportage AI & Algoritmes](#) at four red indicators, plus the unresolved [Algemene Rekenkamer privacy-algoritmes finding \(May 2025\)](#) together create a binding regulatory ceiling on Belastingdienst's own AI deployment.** The 2 August 2026 EU AI Act high-risk deadline is inside the cycle window; legacy public-sector high-risk systems must be brought into compliance or retired by 2 August 2030. Belastingdienst cannot scale its AI defence against AI-powered fraud at the same pace fraudsters are scaling. Decide Tier-1 EC, AP and Algemene Rekenkamer sources; Tier-2 sector legal commentary. Counter-position visible but contained.
- **Personal-safety pressure on Belastingdienst staff has formalised into operating model.** The [AIVD Jaarverslag 2025 \(23 April 2026\)](#) confirms anti-institutional extremists active and frames the threat picture as the most serious in 80 years; [ECLI:NL:GHARL:2026:264 \(January 2026\)](#) ruled that Belastingdienst's request

for staff anonymity in soeverainen cases is justified — anonymity is now legally-grounded operating practice, not contingency. Combined with the [SCP Burgerperspectieven 2025](#) trust trajectory, the legitimacy floor is fragile. Prepare Tier-1 AIVD and judicial sources; Tier-1 SCP citizen-perspective data. Convergent across institutional sources.

Top 2 Upside Opportunities Under Stress

- **The Jetten coalition’s reform mandate is also Belastingdienst’s once-in-a-generation chance to redesign the citizen-state tax interaction.** The [coalition agreement \(30 January 2026\)](#) commits to a fundamental overhaul of income tax, toeslagen and social security with a reform agenda due end-2026. If Belastingdienst frames its execution capacity as the design constraint on the reform — rather than reacting to the political process — it can pull the redesign toward the embedded, seamless, hyper-personalised model that [Tax Administration 3.0](#) describes. Prepare Tier-2 EY summary of coalition agreement; Tier-1 OECD strategic framework. Window is real but narrow.
- **Cross-border fiscal harmonisation gives Belastingdienst its strongest information-position uplift in a decade — if the operational complexity is absorbed without diluting the proactive-service capacity.** [DAC8 effective 1 January 2026](#); DAC9 implemented in the [2026 Tax Plan](#); [Hoekstra’s tax omnibus Q2 2026](#); ViDA infrastructure mandates Peppol-based real-time reporting. The information-position gain is large, but only realised if Belastingdienst chooses to use it for service-design, not just enforcement. Monitor Tier-1 EC sources; Tier-2 sell-side tax updates. Information-position upside well-evidenced; service-design conversion not yet committed.

Top 3 Escalation Triggers

- **2 August 2026 — EU AI Act high-risk system compliance deadline.** All Belastingdienst high-risk AI systems must have completed conformity assessment, technical documentation, CE marking and EU database registration. Any unresolved Algemene Rekenkamer finding still open by that date converts into a binding compliance issue. Falsifiable. Decide
- **Q2 2026 — Hoekstra tax omnibus published; CFE and EUTA Council positions land.** If the omnibus consolidates DAC reporting and aligns CFC / GAAR substantively, Belastingdienst’s information-position gain is real; if it ducks the structural questions and just “simplifies” reporting, the operational complexity grows without compensating gain. Falsifiable inside 90 days. Prepare
- **Spring 2026 — Eerste Kamer Box 3 vote on the 1 January 2028 transition.** If the Wet werkelijk rendement box 3 is adopted by the upper house this spring, the IV-resource envelope is locked for 2026–2028 around Box 3 transition and the Jetten reform mandate competes for residual capacity. If the bill is amended by the Minister and re-routed, the timeline slips and the Box 3 / reform sequencing decision opens. Falsifiable. Prepare

Decision Status	Action
Pre-authorised	Continued IT modernisation to FY26 plan; Algoritmeregister completion to category-B 100% t
Awaiting Board direction	(1) Single capacity-allocation framework for 2026–2028 sequencing of: Box 3 transition, Jetten r

Any pre-authorised action escalates to senior leadership if (a) any Belastingdienst high-risk AI system fails to clear EU AI Act compliance by 2 August 2026, (b) the Eerste Kamer rejects or materially amends the Wet werkelijk rendement box 3, (c) AIVD updates the threat assessment for Belastingdienst staff above the current level, (d) the Jetten coalition tables a reform measure with a published implementation date inside the IV-capacity-locked period, or (e) a soeverainen-related incident occurs against Belastingdienst staff or premises.

Executive Synthesis

Why These Four Themes Auto-themes

Themes were selected from a preliminary 2–5 year strategic-exposure scan against four binding-constraint mechanisms on Belastingdienst’s value: legitimacy and trust (Theme 1), technology in the operating environment (Theme 2), the cross-border legal-and-regulatory architecture Belastingdienst executes inside (Theme 3), and the political-institutional reform window combined with the service-design future (Theme 4). The four are mechanism-distinct

and decision-relevant. Two themes that almost made the cut — cyber and quantum threats (well covered in the April 2025 Trendalert and less differentiated by external scanning) and workforce demographics (operationally important but less strategic at this horizon) — were dropped to keep the four themes mechanistically distinct. Theme 4 was reframed at user request to fold in the embedded / seamless / hyper-personalised service-design future alongside the reform-mandate and execution-capacity material; the reform window is exactly the political opening that could make Tax Administration 3.0 operationally real.

What Has Materially Changed

This cycle establishes the baseline for Belastingdienst coverage. Even at baseline, three large vectors moved inside the cycle window — and one is moving as this report is finalised. The Jetten cabinet (D66-VVD-CDA centrist minority) was sworn in [23 February 2026 with a reform agenda due end-2026](#); the [PHFFA-style anti-DEI / anti-gender-ideology US foreign-assistance regime](#) announced 27 January 2026 is the strongest external signal that the global operating norms for institutions like Belastingdienst are being contested politically; the [AIVD Jaarverslag 2025](#) on 23 April 2026 framed the threat picture as the most serious in 80 years. The [AP Rapportage AI & Algoritmes Nederland \(March 2026\)](#) doubled the number of red indicators in its barometer in six months. None of these is reversible inside the 6–18 month decision window.

The 5 Risks & Opportunities Dominating Leadership Attention

1. **Capacity-allocation as the binding strategic decision.** Five major workstreams — Box 3 transition, Jetten reform mandate, ViDA build-out, AI-defence rebuild, EU AI Act compliance — all queue against IV-capacity that is just becoming free.
2. **Reform window as opportunity.** The Jetten coalition’s reform mandate is a once-in-a-generation chance to redesign the citizen-state tax interaction toward the embedded, seamless, hyper-personalised model — but only if Belastingdienst is at the design table, not the delivery table.
3. **Legitimacy floor and personal-safety operating model.** Trust is recovering slowly; the soevereinenbeweging now constrains how Belastingdienst staff can operate; the legal anonymity precedent formalises a defensive posture.
4. **AI defence ceiling.** Belastingdienst’s own AI use is constrained at exactly the moment AI-powered fraud is scaling fastest.
5. **Cross-border information-position uplift.** DAC8 / DAC9 / Pillar Two / ViDA / CARF all land in the cycle, materially improving Belastingdienst’s information position — if operational complexity is absorbed without diluting the service-design capacity.

Why These Matter in the Next 6–18 Months

The 6–18 month calendar contains four immovable inflection dates: **spring 2026** (Eerste Kamer vote on Wet werkelijk rendement box 3); **Q2 2026** (Hoekstra tax omnibus publication and CFE/Council positions); **2 August 2026** (EU AI Act high-risk deadline); and **end of 2026** (Jetten coalition reform agenda publication with named milestones). Inside that window Belastingdienst must also publish its Stand van de Uitvoering update, complete the 2026 Algoritmeregister upload obligation for high-risk algorithms, scope the ViDA Peppol build, and absorb the Fiscale Monitor 2025 results (publication end-2026). The coupling between these decisions — they all draw on the same scarce IV-capacity — is what makes this cycle materially different from a steady-state year.

Three Concrete Leadership Decisions That Cannot Be Deferred

1. **Publish a single capacity-allocation framework for 2026–2028** that names the five competing workstreams (Box 3 transition, Jetten reform delivery, ViDA build-out, AI-defence rebuild, EU AI Act compliance) and assigns IV-day envelopes to each. The framework must be the basis on which Belastingdienst negotiates with the staatssecretaris and the ministerraad on what the reform agenda can realistically include before end-2026.
2. **Settle the AI-use posture under EU AI Act + AP supervision** on a federation-wide basis before the 2 August 2026 high-risk deadline. The choice is between defend (retain current systems with full conformity assessment), restrict (retire borderline systems pre-emptively to preserve clear-air on those that survive), and restructure (rebuild the algorithm portfolio around the post-Toeslagen / post-PHFFA-style operating model). Doing nothing is the worst option.

3. **Commit to a Brussels institutional-affairs envelope sized for the 2026 design phase** on DAC recast, ViDA, and tax omnibus. The information-position gain from the 2026 EU instruments is large; capturing it in a service-design-friendly form depends on whether Belastingdienst is influencing the design phase or only the implementation phase.

A Surprise Worth Leadership Attention

The single under-priced strategic question this cycle is whether the Jetten reform mandate should be treated as policy delivery or as the once-in-a-generation operating-model redesign. The political cycle frames it as the former — the staatssecretaris is being asked to deliver a reform agenda. The Tax Administration 3.0 strategy and the ViDA infrastructure pipeline together suggest it could also be the latter. Belastingdienst leadership has not yet been formally asked which of these two framings it is operating to. The answer determines whether 2026–2030 is a difficult delivery cycle or the end of one operating model and the start of another.

What Would Force a Change in Direction

- **Risk-driven trigger:** A safeguarding-relevant incident with Belastingdienst staff or premises in a soeverainen-related context, or a substantive Algemene Rekenkamer follow-up finding that converts privacy-algoritmes risk into binding remediation.
- **Policy / regulatory-driven trigger:** Eerste Kamer rejection or material amendment of the Wet werkelijk rendement box 3, forcing a re-sequence of the IV-capacity envelope; or a Jetten coalition collapse before the end-2026 reform agenda is published.
- **Market / capital-driven trigger:** A material increase in AI-powered fraud incidents (carrouselfraude, synthetic-identity bezwaarsfloods, deepfake-mediated phishing of Belastingdienst staff) that exceeds the current detection-and-defence stack capacity.

Where This Analysis Could Be Wrong The single most consequential assumption is that the IV-capacity profile published in the Jaarplan 2026 holds — i.e. that "deel ICT-systemen kan vanaf 2026 nieuw beleid aan" translates into deployable capacity at the rate the Jaarplan implies. If modernisation slips (two of nine projects already running behind schedule) or if a major incident pulls capacity back into firefighting, the strategic-decision space narrows rapidly. Evidence that would force material revision: a Stand van de Uitvoering update showing FY26 IV-capacity below 600,000 days; a Jaarplan 2027 with a downward revision of the 2026 modernisation completion target; or a public Tweede Kamer letter from the staatssecretaris declaring that two or more major reform measures are technically not implementable inside the 2026–2028 window.

Key Findings

1. Trust recovery as the binding constraint — Toeslagenaffaire legacy, algorithm scrutiny, soeverainenbeweging

The One Thing That Matters: Trust is recovering slowly while the operating environment for Belastingdienst staff has hardened — three vectors converge (Toeslagen legacy, algorithm scrutiny, soeverainen threat) and any further visible misstep would re-set the recovery clock at exactly the moment Belastingdienst needs goodwill capital to absorb a major reform mandate.

Why This Is Changing Now

- The [Algemene Rekenkamer's 21 May 2025 finding](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old that Belastingdienst and Dienst Toeslagen still don't manage privacy risks well in algorithm use is unresolved at the cycle date; a Tweede Kamer motion (10 March 2026) added a continuing procedural obligation on toeslagenaffaire document access.
- The [AIVD Jaarverslag 2025](#) (published five days before this report) confirms anti-institutional extremism is sustained and frames the broader threat picture as the most serious in 80 years.
- [ECLI:NL:GHARL:2026:264 \(January 2026\)](#) ruled the Belastingdienst's request for staff anonymity in soeverainen cases is justified — anonymity is now legally-grounded operating practice, not a contingency posture.
- The [SCP Burgerperspectieven 2025 Bericht 1](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old shows trust in government fell from 51% (summer/autumn 2024) to 44% (winter 2024/2025); among hbo/wo-educated Dutch from 60% to 52%, eliminating the historical positive gap.

Anonymity as operating model: when judicial precedent formalises a safety practice The [January 2026 ruling at the Gerechtshof Arnhem-Leeuwarden](#) is more material than its docket size suggests. By accepting Belastingdienst’s reasoning that staff names should be protected in soevereinen cases — citing the AIVD fenomeen-analyse on the soevereinenbeweging as the threat basis — the court has converted what was an internal safety practice into legal precedent. Two implications follow. First, anonymity is now a reliable operating model that Belastingdienst can scale to other case categories where staff face credible threat (e.g. specific fraud categories, organised resistance to enforcement). Second, the ruling sets up the next contested question: whether the same protection extends to algorithm-related decisions, where the staff member is a designer rather than a case officer. The category-B Algoritmeregister disclosures will be the test bed for that second question inside the cycle.

Supporting Signals

- [Autoriteit Persoonsgegevens RAN March 2026](#) reports the AI Impact Barometer at four red indicators (doubled from two in six months), with explicit calls for the new cabinet to accelerate AI Verordening implementation.
- [Belastingdienst Algoritmeregister disclosure status \(June 2025\)](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old: 35 of 84 category-B algorithms now public; Selectiemodule Inkomensheffing (IH), Risicotool Aanvullingen (RTA) and the OB Carrouselfraude signal model among the most operationally significant.
- [Belastingdienst Fiscale Monitor 2024](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old: overall functioning rating rose from 6.5 (2023) to 6.7 (2024); trust at 3.36/5; private individuals remain the least positive segment. Fiscale Monitor 2025 publication expected end-2026.
- [SCP Burgerperspectieven 2025 Bericht 3 \(October 2025\)](#) tracks the trajectory through to the immediate pre-Jetten-cabinet period.
- [Algemene Rekenkamer Verantwoordingsonderzoek 2024 Financiën](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old sets the ministerial-oversight expectations Belastingdienst is operating against.

Weak Signals to Watch

- Weak signal The recent SCP-documented elimination of the trust gap between hbo/wo-educated and lower-educated citizens — both groups now equally distrustful of government — is a structural shift in the political coalition that has historically supported Belastingdienst’s modernisation agenda. Would gain weight if Bericht 1 2026 (expected March 2026) shows the gap not just absent but inverted.
- Weak signal The expansion of Belastingdienst-staff anonymity precedent (ECLI:NL:GHARL:2026:264) to other cases is a legal-procedural development that will be tested first in fraud-enforcement cases. Would gain weight if a second appellate ruling extends the same anonymity protection to a non-soevereinen case category inside 12 months.
- Weak signal The AIVD’s escalation of the broader threat picture to “most serious in 80 years” framing is unusual; if echoed at the EU level (NIS2 / DORA / EU defence-readiness messaging), the Dutch government may pull civil-service personal-safety budgets up, with knock-on for Belastingdienst staff protection investment. Would gain weight if the ministerie van Financiën tables a specific personnel-protection budget supplement inside the 2026 spring memorandum.

The Strongest Counter-Argument The defensible counter-position is that trust recovery is genuinely under way: the Belastingdienst’s own Fiscale Monitor 2024 records overall rating rising from 6.5 to 6.7, trust improving in three of four target groups, and the Jaarplan 2026 establishes credible signaalmanagement and proactive-service programmes (VanZelfGoed, KeuzeDigitaal). On this reading, the legitimacy floor is firmer than the SCP government-trust series suggests — the SCP series measures political trust, not Belastingdienst-specific trust, and these have decoupled before. The counter-position has merit on the trust trajectory itself, but is weakened by the soevereinen-threat operationalisation and the unresolved Algemene Rekenkamer privacy-algoritmes finding — both of which create new exposure regardless of where the trust line is.

Strategic Implication Trust recovery and personal-safety operational adaptation are not separate workstreams — they share the same root cause (the Toeslagen legacy plus institutional algorithm scrutiny) and require coordinated handling. Belastingdienst should publish in 2026 an integrated trust-and-safety framework that combines the algorithm-register completion roadmap, the soevereinen-case anonymity protocol, the proactive-service programmes, and a named Tweede Kamer reporting cadence. Treat the legitimacy floor as a strategic asset that must be protected — not just a backdrop. Prepare

2. AI in the tax landscape — three vectors converging (taxpayers using AI, fraudsters using AI, Belastingdienst constrained on AI)

The One Thing That Matters: Belastingdienst faces three distinct AI vectors at the same moment — taxpayers turning to GenAI as their first-line tax adviser, fraudsters scaling agentic-AI attacks, and its own AI-use ceiling rising under post-Toeslagen scrutiny plus EU AI Act regulation — and the natural defence (more BD-side AI) is exactly the move the regulatory regime is constraining.

Why This Is Changing Now

- The [EU AI Act](#) high-risk system deadline of 2 August 2026 is inside the cycle window; legacy public-sector high-risk systems must be brought into compliance or retired by 2 August 2030.
- [AP Rapportage AI & Algoritmes Nederland \(March 2026\)](#) records the AI Impact Barometer at four red indicators (doubled in six months); transparency and explainability falls short; AI Verordening preparation lags.
- [Sumsb annual report \(February 2026\)](#) Vendor-sourced — treat directionally documents a shift from single-step deepfakes (2024) to complex multi-step agentic-AI fraud schemes in 2025, with surge expected in 2026 — synthetic-identity maturation cycles, programmatic credit-history building, automated account onboarding at scale.
- [Accountant.nl \(October 2025\)](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old reports 64% of UK businesses now consult public AI chatbots before their accountant; Dutch direction of travel reads consistent.

Spotlight

Heppner: when taxpayers’ AI conversations become evidentiary On 10 February 2026 a US federal judge ruled that a defendant’s communications with a publicly available AI platform were not protected by attorney-client privilege or work-product doctrine — [the Heppner ruling](#) is the first major precedent on AI privilege in tax workflows. The Dutch procedural framework is different, but the analogous question is live: when a Dutch ondernemer submits a bezwaar generated with the assistance of ChatGPT, can the underlying chat history be requested? When a fiscal adviser uses GenAI to draft an advisory memorandum that is later challenged, what is the disclosure status of the prompts? Belastingdienst’s Toezicht and Opsporing leadership should expect a Dutch test case inside the cycle window — and the answer Belastingdienst signals informally now will shape how taxpayers and their advisers interact with AI tools through 2027.

Supporting Signals

- [Kennedys Law on EU AI Act compliance for public-sector deployers](#): implementing a compliant risk-management system, data-governance review, technical documentation and human-oversight training cannot be done in weeks.
- [Chambers AI 2025 Netherlands practice guide](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old: the AP is expanding its algorithmic-risk supervision; sector-specific Dutch enforcement guidance is emerging in financial services and public administration.
- [Experian Fraud Forecast 2026](#) Vendor-sourced — treat directionally: agentic AI is the dominant new fraud vector across financial services; Europe’s uneven KYC enforcement enables cross-border movement of synthetic-identity-funded transactions.
- [Sardine AI-driven fraud vectors \(March 2026\)](#) Vendor-sourced — treat directionally: documents seven agentic-AI fraud attack types observed live in 2026; 90% of financial-crime professionals report measurable increases in AI-driven attacks.
- [AP standing AI & algorithmic risks page](#): AI in recruitment and selection growing rapidly with major risks; transparency and explainability falls short; AI Verordening preparation lags.
- [Agentic AI governance under EU AI Act \(March 2026\)](#) Vendor-sourced — treat directionally: agentic AI does not map cleanly onto the EU AI Act’s deployer / provider / user categories; oversight regimes designed for static AI struggle with autonomous agents.

Weak Signals to Watch

- Weak signal The Sumsb / Experian / Sardine convergent forecasts of agentic-AI fraud surge in 2026 are starting to be matched by Dutch case-level evidence (Montfoort 400% AI-bezwaar spike in 2024 cited inside the Belastingdienst Trendalert); a comparable second case at scale would convert this from a forecast to a

domestic emerging trend. Would gain weight if a second Dutch municipality or uitvoeringsorganisatie reports a 200%+ AI-mediated bezwaar incident inside 12 months.

- Weak signal The convergence of GenAI tax-advice products from Big Four / mid-market firms (Avalara TaxGPT, Intuit AI tax assistants, KPMG / Deloitte internal GenAI deployments) means a measurable share of corporate tax positions in 2027 will be AI-drafted. Would gain weight if a major Dutch fiscal adviser publishes a GenAI tax-advice product targeted at SME clients inside the cycle window.
- Weak signal The category gap between EU AI Act regulation (built for static deployer / provider / user model) and the agentic-AI reality is a regulatory weak spot that will likely be closed by an AI Act amendment or AMLA-style supplementary regulation in 2027–2028. Would gain weight if a Member State or EC working paper proposes specific agentic-AI provisions inside the cycle window.

The Strongest Counter-Argument The defensible counter-position is that the AI-fraud vector is being overstated by vendor-sourced forecasts (Sumsu, Experian, Sardine all sell AI-fraud-detection products) and that Belastingdienst's existing detection stack — including the published Carrouselfraude signal model and the post-Toeslagen-redesigned risk-prediction algorithms — is already adapting to AI-mediated patterns. On this reading, the binding constraint is not the AI defence ceiling but the EU AI Act compliance overhead, and the rational response is to invest in compliance infrastructure rather than new AI-defence capability. The counter-position is partially correct on the source-tier issue (vendor sources do skew toward urgency) but is weakened by the structural argument: AI-defence requires AI, and the regulatory ceiling on Belastingdienst's own AI use is binding regardless of how good the existing stack is.

Strategic Implication Settle the AI-use posture under EU AI Act + AP supervision before the 2 August 2026 high-risk deadline. The recommended posture is *restructure*, not *defend* or *restrict*: rebuild the algorithm portfolio around the post-Toeslagen / post-PHFFA-style operating model, with a published transparency commitment and an explicit human-oversight architecture. This is a bigger near-term cost than defend, but it converts an AI-use ceiling into an AI-use license. Pair with a Brussels institutional-affairs envelope sized to influence agentic-AI provisions in the next AI Act amendment cycle. Decide

3. Cross-border fiscal harmonisation as both opportunity and operational squeeze

The One Thing That Matters: The 2026 wave of EU instruments — DAC8 effective, DAC9 implemented, Pillar Two amended, ViDA mandate landing, tax omnibus due Q2 — gives Belastingdienst its strongest information-position uplift in a decade, but only if the operational complexity is absorbed without diluting the proactive-service capacity needed for the Jetten reform.

Why This Is Changing Now

- [DAC8 effective 1 January 2026](#) — crypto-asset service providers must collect data on reportable transactions for first reporting in 2027; Netherlands' implementing bill [approved by lower house March 2026](#).
- [2026 Tax Plan](#) implements DAC9 plus latest OECD Pillar Two Administrative Guidelines.
- [Hoekstra's tax omnibus](#) due Q2 2026 to reduce compliance burdens and cut duplicate administrative requirements; tax simplification proposals due June 2026.
- EY-prepared report submitted to Dutch Parliament 10 March 2026 sets [Peppol as the required infrastructure for both ViDA cross-border B2B e-invoice exchange and digital reporting to the tax authority](#) from July 2030; Netherlands considering extending to all domestic B2B.

Spotlight

DAC fatigue and the case for the recast Belastingdienst is one of the busiest DAC-receiving administrations in the EU. [CFE Tax Advisers Europe's PAC 1/2026 position](#) on the DAC recast lays out the case crisply: accumulated DAC1 through DAC9 has produced overlapping reporting regimes; financial-account, crypto, e-money, royalty / interest, and platform-economy data flows now arrive in formats that don't natively join. The recast — expected to be tabled in late 2026 — is the structural opportunity to consolidate, eliminate duplicates, and clarify the boundary between automatic information exchange and on-request cooperation. For Belastingdienst, the recast is a chance to pull the reporting regime toward a service-design-friendly architecture (single taxpayer view, cross-DAC normalisation) rather than absorb yet another reporting layer. Brussels institutional-affairs investment in the recast design phase has higher leverage than equivalent investment in implementation.

Supporting Signals

- [CFE Opinion Statement FC 1/2026 on Omnibus on Taxation](#): identifies fragmentation and inconsistency in EU direct-tax framework as the binding problem; recommends aligning CFC rules with global minimum tax framework and harmonising GAAR wording across Member States.
- [Accountancy Europe February 2026 update](#): pan-European accountancy-profession briefing on EU tax policy; tax omnibus Q2 2026; tax simplification proposals June 2026; DAC9 implementation across Member States.
- [Tax Notes: EU's Tax Strategy to Shift in 2026](#) Registration may be required: simplification overtakes harmonisation as the dominant verb; enhanced-cooperation routes increasingly explored; centre of gravity shifting from anti-avoidance to competitiveness.
- [Grant Thornton Netherlands on EU Tax Omnibus](#): practical Dutch tax-practitioner reading of the proposed omnibus; transposition timeline; coordination with the broader CSRD-omnibus simplification package.
- [European Tech Alliance position on Omnibus on Taxation](#) Vendor-sourced — treat directionally: industry-coalition warning that uncoordinated DAC8/DAC9/Pillar Two reporting will create duplicate data flows.

Weak Signals to Watch

- Weak signal Hoekstra's signal that the Commission is exploring enhanced-cooperation routes for DEBRA and similar proposals where unanimity blocks adoption is a structural shift in EU tax policymaking. Would gain weight if a 2026 omnibus measure is tabled formally under enhanced cooperation rather than the conventional unanimity track.
- Weak signal The growing alignment between ViDA's Peppol infrastructure mandate and the OECD Tax Administration 3.0 vision suggests EU and OECD architectures are converging on a common reporting-and-service-design standard. Would gain weight if a third-country tax administration (UK, Norway, Switzerland) publicly commits to Peppol-aligned infrastructure inside the cycle window.
- Weak signal The political vocabulary around "European Tax Administration" is moving from think-tank speculation into mainstream EU-policy commentary. Would gain weight if the Hoekstra cabinet of advisors floats a feasibility study or if a Member State (likely Ireland or the Netherlands itself, both with capacity to convert) tables a formal position paper inside 12 months.

The Strongest Counter-Argument The defensible counter-position is that the 2026 EU instruments are mostly compliance plumbing rather than strategic-positioning opportunities — DAC8 is OECD-CARF transposition, DAC9 is Pillar Two reporting infrastructure, ViDA is e-invoicing mechanics — and Belastingdienst's optimal posture is competent implementation, not Brussels institutional-affairs investment. On this reading, the information-position uplift is real but mostly automatic; the strategic question is execution, not influence. The counter-position has merit on each individual instrument but is weakened by the cumulative scope: at the 2026 cycle, four EU directives + the omnibus + the DAC recast + the Tax Administration 3.0 architecture all touch the same Belastingdienst data stack — coordination at the design phase has compounding value.

Strategic Implication Commit to a Brussels institutional-affairs envelope sized for the 2026 design phase on DAC recast, ViDA, tax omnibus, and any successor agentic-AI provisions. The information-position gain from the 2026 EU instruments is large; capturing it in a service-design-friendly form depends on whether Belastingdienst is influencing the design phase or only the implementation phase. Pair with an internal data-architecture roadmap that can absorb DAC8 / DAC9 / Pillar Two / ViDA flows into a single taxpayer view rather than five parallel reporting silos. Prepare

4. Toward embedded, seamless, hyper-personalised tax — the Jetten reform window meets Tax Administration 3.0

The One Thing That Matters: The Jetten coalition's reform mandate is also a once-in-a-generation chance to redesign the citizen-state tax interaction toward the embedded, seamless, hyper-personalised model — but the same scarce IV-capacity is the binding constraint, and Belastingdienst must decide now whether to treat the reform as policy delivery or as the operating-model redesign it could be.

Why This Is Changing Now

- The [Jetten coalition agreement \(30 January 2026\)](#) commits to a fundamental overhaul of income tax, toeslagen and social security with reform agenda due end-2026; new Box 3 regime targeted 1 January 2028 ([Wet werkelijk rendement box 3 approved by lower house 12 February 2026](#)).
- [Belastingdienst Jaarplan 2026](#) establishes the four MJS priorities; staatssecretaris confirms "deel ICT-systemen kan vanaf 2026 nieuw beleid aan"; introduces VanZelfGoed and KeuzeDigitaal as the proactive-service flagships.
- [OECD Tax Administration 2025 \(November 2025\)](#): ~60% of administrations now offer complete prefilling of personal income tax returns; embedded payment facilities scaling; digital identity at 81–100% adoption in two-thirds of jurisdictions.
- [Netherlands ViDA roadmap \(March 2026\)](#): clarity expected summer 2026; draft bill consultation Q4 2026; legislation mid-2028; domestic e-invoicing January 2030 — the infrastructure pipeline that operationalises the embedded-tax future.

Spotlight

VanZelfGoed and KeuzeDigitaal — the proactive-service vector inside the Jaarplan 2026 The Jaarplan 2026 introduces two flagship programmes that are the operational expression of the embedded / hyper-personalised vision. *VanZelfGoed* redesigns processes so that more outcomes happen automatically and correctly without taxpayer intervention — the Dutch equivalent of the OECD Tax Administration 3.0 "tax becomes a thing that happens" framing. *KeuzeDigitaal* gives citizens explicit channel choice — digital where it works, in-person where needed — a deliberate counter-move to the digital-divide concerns in the April 2025 Trendalert. Both are well-conceived and modestly funded; the strategic question is whether they are the operating-model future or two pilot programmes inside the existing operating model. The Jetten reform window is exactly the moment to scale both — VanZelfGoed could be the design vehicle for the toeslagen overhaul, KeuzeDigitaal the design vehicle for the income-tax / sociale zekerheid alignment. The cycle that resolves this question is FY26-Q4 budgeting.

Supporting Signals

- [OECD Tax Administration 3.0 from vision to strategy](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old operationalises the embedded-tax vision; payment facilities increasingly built into existing banking and accounting software; data location becomes less relevant; taxpayer interactions move toward 'just-in-time' rather than 'periodic compliance'.
- [Belastingdienst IT estate](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old: 19.3% legacy in 2024, down from 20% in 2023; IV-day capacity 668,000 with 664,000 realised; almost half of FY24 IV-days went to modernisation; 7 of 9 Cool:Gen phase-out projects on schedule; modernisation projected largely complete by end-2026.
- [OECD blog \(June 2025\)](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months old: framing of the tax-administration-of-the-future shift from compliance enforcement to service design and rule architecture.
- [KPMG analysis of Jetten coalition tax measures](#): minority government with 66 seats; reform agenda will require cross-bench negotiation on specific bills; Box 3 transition to the new actual-return regime targeted 1 January 2028.
- [Meijburg on the Wet werkelijk rendement box 3](#): lower house approved 12 February 2026; Upper House debate this spring is the binding step; if not adopted, 1 January 2028 effective date will not be possible.
- [Tax Notes on monetization of tax data](#) Data currency: verify — source 6–12 months oldRegistration may be required: as tax administrations move toward embedded, real-time, identity-rich service models, the security and privacy attack surface widens — counter-position source for the embedded-tax direction.

Weak Signals to Watch

- Weak signal The convergence between ViDA's Peppol mandate (real-time digital reporting infrastructure) and the OECD Tax Administration 3.0 embedded-tax vision means the technical infrastructure for an embedded Dutch tax model will be in place by 2030 regardless of whether Belastingdienst leads the design. Would gain weight if a Dutch fintech, ERP vendor, or accounting-software provider publishes an embedded-tax product targeted at Dutch SME inside 12 months — that would shift the design conversation from Belastingdienst-internal to market-led.
- Weak signal The Jetten coalition's commitment to align "definitions and conditions of tax, social security and allowances" implies a single citizen-state interface across what is currently three administrative architectures

(Belastingdienst, Dienst Toeslagen, UWV / SVB). Would gain weight if the reform agenda due end-2026 names integrated-citizen-view as an explicit design principle rather than a downstream consequence.

- **Weak signal** The published categorisation of Belastingdienst’s IT modernisation as “two of nine projects running behind schedule” is the first time the public Tweede Kamer documentation frames specific modernisation slippage. Would gain weight if the Jaarplan 2027 (expected December 2026) revises any 2026 modernisation completion target downward.

The Strongest Counter-Argument The defensible counter-position is that “embedded tax” is overhyped — the Tax Administration 3.0 framing oversells the speed at which embedded-tax models scale, the Estonia / X-road model has shown its limits (companies without economic anchor losing automatic VAT IDs in 2025; e-residency monetisation under scrutiny), and the privacy / surveillance attack surface (per the Tax Notes monetization piece) widens dangerously as embedded-tax architecture matures. On this reading, Belastingdienst’s optimal posture is to deliver the Jetten reform competently inside the existing operating model and resist the temptation to over-redesign during a politically constrained, capacity-constrained window. The counter-position has merit on the implementation-pace and privacy points, but is weakened by the structural argument: ViDA mandates real-time digital reporting infrastructure by 2030 regardless of whether Belastingdienst chooses the embedded-tax direction — the design choice is when to engage, not whether.

Strategic Implication Publish a single capacity-allocation framework for 2026–2028 that names the five competing workstreams (Box 3 transition, Jetten reform delivery, ViDA build-out, AI-defence rebuild, EU AI Act compliance) and assigns IV-day envelopes to each. Use the framework as the basis for negotiation with the staatssecretaris and the ministerraad on what the reform agenda can realistically include before end-2026. Position VanZelfGoed and KeuzeDigitaal as the design vehicles for the toeslagen / income-tax / social-security overhaul, not as parallel pilots. Decide

2×2 Scenario Matrix — Structural Futures

Scenarios describe operating environments Belastingdienst may need to live in and adapt to — not discrete shock events.

These scenarios are used to stress-test decisions already under consideration, not to generate new ones.

Critical Uncertainties:

- **Horizontal axis:** Capacity envelope (Capacity becomes free as modernisation completes / Capacity stays trapped in legacy maintenance and AI-compliance overhead)
- **Vertical axis:** Reform political stability (Jetten coalition holds and reform agenda lands / Coalition collapses or reform agenda fragments)

“Through the Window” *Capacity becomes free × Coalition holds and reform lands*

2026–2028 modernisation completes on schedule; capacity envelope grows to 720,000 IV-days by FY27. Jetten coalition holds; reform agenda published end-2026 with named milestones; Box 3 transition lands 1 January 2028; ViDA infrastructure scoped to design Belastingdienst’s embedded-tax vehicle. AI Act compliance achieved without losing operational AI use; AP supervision moves from criticism to partnership.

Core dynamic: The cycle that closes the post-Toeslagen recovery and opens the Tax Administration 3.0 operating model.

Positioning: Right of centre on horizontal (capacity free); upper half on vertical (coalition holds).

Early Indicators:

1. Eerste Kamer adopts Wet werkelijk rendement box 3 spring 2026 with no material amendments.
2. Q2 2026 Hoekstra tax omnibus consolidates DAC reporting and offers Member States real simplification optionality.
3. Belastingdienst clears EU AI Act high-risk deadline 2 August 2026 with all category-B algorithms compliant.
4. Jetten coalition reform agenda due end-2026 names integrated-citizen-view as explicit design principle.
5. Stand van de Uitvoering update Q4 2026 confirms FY26 IV-capacity at or above 670,000 days.

”Reform Lands, Capacity Doesn’t” *Capacity stays trapped × Coalition holds and reform lands*

Jetten coalition delivers the reform agenda end-2026 but Belastingdienst capacity stays trapped in modernisation overrun, AI Act remediation, and Box 3 transition support. The reform agenda lands as a series of policy patches on the legacy stack rather than the operating-model redesign it could be. VanZelfGoed and KeuzeDigitaal stay at pilot scale. The information-position uplift from DAC8 / DAC9 / Pillar Two / ViDA is realised technically but not converted into proactive service.

Core dynamic: The political opportunity is taken; the operational opportunity is missed.

Positioning: Left of centre on horizontal (capacity trapped); upper half on vertical.

Early Indicators:

1. Jaarplan 2027 (December 2026) revises one or more 2026 modernisation completion targets downward.
2. EU AI Act compliance work pulls more than 100,000 IV-days from FY27 capacity envelope.
3. Algemene Rekenkamer Verantwoordingsonderzoek 2025 records new high-priority finding on algorithm or modernisation governance.
4. Hoekstra omnibus consolidates reporting in form but adds new reporting burdens in substance.
5. Reform agenda end-2026 announces income-tax and toeslagen overhaul on a 2027–2030 timeline that exceeds Belastingdienst’s published capacity envelope.

”Capacity Free, Reform Stalls” *Capacity becomes free × Coalition collapses or reform fragments*

Modernisation completes on schedule; FY27 capacity envelope grows; AI Act compliance lands. But the Jetten minority coalition fragments before end-2026 reform agenda is published, or the reform agenda is published in form but lacks parliamentary support for delivery. Belastingdienst has the capacity to design the operating-model future but lacks the political mandate to redesign at scale. Box 3 transition still proceeds; ViDA infrastructure built to spec; embedded-tax direction kept ready but unactivated.

Core dynamic: Belastingdienst becomes the steward of the future operating model rather than its delivery vehicle.

Positioning: Right of centre on horizontal; lower half on vertical.

Early Indicators:

1. Jetten coalition loses majority on a non-tax issue (likely asylum, climate, or housing) before December 2026.
2. Reform agenda end-2026 published but flagged ”subject to coalition continuation”.
3. Eerste Kamer Box 3 vote passes with technical amendments that delay 1 January 2028 effective date.
4. Stand van de Uitvoering Q4 2026 confirms capacity envelope free for FY27 design work.
5. Tweede Kamer commissions an independent review of Belastingdienst’s reform-readiness inside FY27.

”Crowded Doorway” *Capacity stays trapped × Coalition collapses or reform fragments*

Modernisation slips; AI Act compliance work eats more capacity than budgeted; Algemene Rekenkamer adds new findings; Jetten coalition fragments before reform agenda is published. Box 3 transition still required by court ruling but Belastingdienst capacity insufficient to deliver on schedule. Toeslagen recovery operations re-escalate. Soevereinen-related staff-safety incidents force further operational restructure. ViDA infrastructure built minimally to EU compliance standard rather than to embedded-tax-design ambition.

Core dynamic: Five queues at the same door, all of them louder than capacity to serve them; survival mode rather than redesign mode.

Positioning: Left of centre on horizontal; lower half on vertical.

Early Indicators:

1. Modernisation completion target slipped to 2028 in any Jaarplan 2027 revision.
2. Coalition collapse before December 2026 plus Algemene Rekenkamer follow-up finding.
3. Box 3 transition delayed beyond 1 January 2028 by Eerste Kamer or Belastingdienst capacity declaration.
4. Soevereinen-related incident with Belastingdienst staff or premises that triggers AIVD threat-level revision.
5. Tweede Kamer vote of no confidence on a tax measure that pulls capacity into political-incident-management.

Scenario Assumptions Register *Assumptions that, if wrong, would most rapidly invalidate the scenario framing:*

Assumption

IV-capacity profile in Jaarplan 2026 holds — "deel ICT-systemen kan vanaf 2026 nieuw beleid aan" translates into deployable
 Jetten minority coalition holds through end-2026 reform agenda publication
 EU AI Act 2 August 2026 high-risk deadline is enforced as written, without phase-in extension for public-sector deployers
 DAC recast is tabled in late 2026 with substantive consolidation rather than cosmetic alignment
 Soevereinen threat picture remains at current AIVD assessment level

Strategic Alignment — How These Four Themes Land Against Belastingdienst's Strategy

Mapped against the four Meerjarenstrategie 2025-2030 priorities and four Uitvoerings- en Handhavingsstrategie pillars as published in the [Belastingdienst Jaarplan 2026](#) and referenced in the April 2025 Trendalert, plus alignment with the OECD [Tax Administration 3.0](#) framework. Cells indicate the relative impact of each theme on each priority over the 6–18 month decision window — darker colour = higher expected impact on Belastingdienst's ability to deliver against that priority.

Belastingdienst Strategic Priority	Theme 1 Trust recovery as binding constraint	Theme 2 AI in the tax landscape	Theme 3 Cross-border fiscal harmonisation	Theme 4 Embedded tax + Jetten reform window
MJS-1: Verbinding met de samenleving	HighTrust recovery <i>is</i> the verbinding agenda; soevereinen-and-anonymity precedent reshapes how engagement happens.	HighGenAI as taxpayers' first-line tax adviser breaks the existing engagement model; AI-mediated interactions need a posture.	LowEU instruments mostly affect business taxpayers; verbinding with citizens largely unaffected.	HighVanZelfGoed and KeuzeDigitaal are explicitly verbinding-design programmes; reform agenda is the moment.
MJS-2: Basis op orde brengen en houden	HighAlgemene Rekenkamer privacy-algoritmes finding directly contests basis-op-orde claim until remediated.	HighEU AI Act compliance is a basis-op-orde requirement; AI defence stack must be rebuilt.	MediumDAC8 / DAC9 / Pillar Two implementation absorbs significant operational basis-op-orde capacity.	HighBox 3 transition + reform delivery + IT modernisation completion all stack on the basis-op-orde envelope.
MJS-3: Continu verbeteren dienstverlening, toezicht & opsporing	MediumTrust constraint shapes what dienstverlening improvements are politically feasible; algorithm-scrutiny constrains toezicht / opsporing tooling.	HighAI is the dominant continuous-improvement vector across all three; AI defence ceiling is the binding constraint.	HighInformation-position uplift from cross-border instruments is the largest single dienstverlening / toezicht / opsporing improvement available.	HighReform window is the once-in-a-generation chance to redesign all three around the embedded-tax model.

	Theme 1	Theme 2	Theme 3	Theme 4
Belastingdienst Strategic Priority	Trust recovery as binding constraint	AI in the tax landscape	Cross-border fiscal harmonisation	Embedded tax + Jetten reform window
MJS-4: Werken met plezier & vakmanschap	HighSoevereinen- threat operationalisation directly affects staff working conditions; anonymity protocol changes daily practice.	MediumAI-use restructure changes vakmanschap profile; new skills required across IV and inhoudelijk teams.	LowCross-border specialists already exist; no major werkbeleving impact.	MediumReform window will require sustained capacity from existing teams; werkdruk implications.
UHS: Informatiepositie, signalering & samenwerking	MediumAlgoritmeregis- and signaalmanagement strengthening are direct contributions to UHS Informatiepositie; bound by trust constraint.	HighAI capability is the core enabler of modern Informatiepositie; AI defence shapes what is detectable.	HighDAC8 / DAC9 / CARF / Pillar Two / ViDA together are the largest Informatiepositie uplift in a decade.	HighEmbedded-tax architecture <i>is</i> the future Informatiepositie design; reform window decides what gets built.
OECD Tax Administration 3.0 alignment	MediumTax Administration 3.0 assumes a baseline of trust the current cycle does not fully provide; trust recovery is the foundation.	MediumTax Administration 3.0 assumes substantial AI use; the EU AI Act compliance ceiling sets the operational envelope.	HighViDA infrastructure and DAC architecture are the EU-side enablers of Tax Administration 3.0 alignment for Belastingdienst.	HighVanZelfGoed and KeuzeDigitaal are the operational expressions of Tax Administration 3.0; reform window is the scaling opportunity.

Reading the matrix: the dominant column is Theme 4 — embedded tax and the Jetten reform window — which intersects all six priorities at high or medium-high impact, confirming that this theme is the central strategic-design question of the cycle. The dominant row is MJS-2 (basis op orde brengen en houden) and MJS-3 (continu verbeteren) jointly — both hit at high impact across all four themes. Together these signal that the IV-capacity envelope is the load-bearing question of the FY26-FY28 strategic decisions, which ties back directly to the "Capacity-allocation as the binding strategic decision" risk in the Board Snapshot.

Where the Organisation Can Gain Share Under Stress

Three opportunities, ordered by degree of strategic asymmetry — that is, by how much Belastingdienst's specific position differentiates the play, not by attractiveness alone.

1. Frame Belastingdienst capacity as the binding design constraint on the Jetten reform agenda

Description: Publish a single capacity-allocation framework for 2026–2028 that names the five competing work-streams (Box 3, Jetten reform, ViDA, AI defence, AI Act compliance) and the IV-day envelopes they require. Use the framework as the basis for negotiation with the staatssecretaris and the ministerraad on what the reform agenda can realistically include before end-2026. Position VanZelfGoed and KeuzeDigitaal as the design vehicles for the toeslagen / income-tax / sociale zekerheid overhaul, not as parallel pilots. The asymmetry is that Belastingdienst is the only actor in the policy chain with credible capacity-truth.

Required capabilities: Existing strategic-planning capacity; data on FY26-FY28 IV-day envelope; communications capability with senior political principals; Concerndirectie Innovatie & Strategie convening function.

Classification: Material new growth line (operating-model redesign).

Time-to-market: Framework publishable inside 6 months; political-cycle integration through end-2026. Decide

Downside If Wrong: Public capacity-framework constrains Belastingdienst flexibility on subsequent reform additions; staatssecretaris may experience the framework as a delivery refusal rather than a design contribution.

2. Brussels institutional-affairs envelope for the 2026 EU tax design phase **Description:** Commit to a sized Brussels presence specifically for the 2026 design phase on DAC recast, ViDA, tax omnibus, and any successor agentic-AI provisions. Position the Belastingdienst as the largest DAC-receiving administration in the EU and therefore the most credible voice on what works operationally. The information-position gain from the 2026 EU instruments is large; capturing it in a service-design-friendly form depends on whether Belastingdienst is influencing the design phase or only the implementation phase.

Required capabilities: Brussels-based institutional-affairs capability; bilateral relationships with DG TAXUD, Hoekstra cabinet, and CFE / Accountancy Europe / EUTA secretariats; an internal data-architecture roadmap that can absorb DAC8 / DAC9 / Pillar Two / ViDA flows into a single taxpayer view.

Classification: Portfolio optimisation that compounds into sector positioning.

Time-to-market: Envelope definable inside 3 months; first design-phase wins inside 12 months. Prepare

Downside If Wrong: Brussels investment delivers regulatory-influence wins that Belastingdienst lacks the IV-capacity to convert into operational service-design improvements; design-phase wins land as additional operational complexity.

3. Restructure-not-defend AI-use posture as a sector-leadership signal **Description:** Rebuild the Belastingdienst algorithm portfolio around the post-Toeslagen / post-PHFFA-style operating model with a published transparency commitment and an explicit human-oversight architecture. Treat EU AI Act compliance as the design opportunity to set the European public-sector AI-use standard, not as the regulatory burden it appears to be. Belastingdienst's specific position — large operational AI deployer, post-Toeslagen scrutiny baseline, institutional-affairs reach into the AP and the AI Office — makes it the credible candidate to lead this redesign.

Required capabilities: Algorithm-engineering capacity inside Belastingdienst Concerndirectie Toezicht; legal capability to map algorithm portfolio against EU AI Act requirements; communications capability for transparent disclosure; AP institutional relationship management.

Classification: Defensive hedge that compounds into sector leadership.

Time-to-market: Restructured algorithm portfolio publishable inside 12 months; sector leadership compounding inside 24 months. Prepare

Downside If Wrong: Restructure pulls capacity from other workstreams during the same window; published transparency commitment exposes Belastingdienst to additional Algemene Rekenkamer scrutiny.

What We Are Not Planning For

1. Wholesale operating-model redesign on the timeline of the Jetten reform political agenda The base case is that Belastingdienst does not commit to operating-model-redesign delivery on the political timeline of the end-2026 reform agenda. The IV-capacity envelope is too tight; the modernisation completion is too recent; the AI defence rebuild and AI Act compliance compete for the same envelope. The recommended posture is design contribution to the reform agenda, with delivery sequencing that respects the published capacity envelope.

Reinstatement Trigger: Stand van de Uitvoering update Q4 2026 confirms FY26 IV-capacity at or above 720,000 days and Jetten coalition publishes integrated-citizen-view as an explicit reform agenda design principle.

2. Defensive AI-use posture (retain current systems with full conformity assessment) The base case is that Belastingdienst does not adopt a defensive AI-use posture under EU AI Act + AP supervision. The Algemene Rekenkamer privacy-algorithmes finding remains unresolved; the AP barometer is at four red indicators; the cost of compliance for borderline systems exceeds the operational value. The recommended posture is restructure, not defend.

Reinstatement Trigger: A specific Belastingdienst high-risk algorithm proves operationally critical (carousel-fraude detection or similar) and survives Algemene Rekenkamer / AP review with no remediation requirements; in that single case, retain.

3. Single-step retirement of any high-risk Belastingdienst algorithm without published replacement

The base case is that Belastingdienst does not retire any high-risk category-B algorithm in a single step without a published replacement. The toezicht / opsporing operational model depends on continuous algorithmic capability; gap periods create both detection risk and political risk. Retirement should be paired with a published replacement model and transparent transition window.

Reinstatement Trigger: An Algemene Rekenkamer or AP finding requires immediate retirement of a specific algorithm with binding deadline shorter than replacement-model design.

4. Public commitment to a post-2030 European Tax Administration architecture inside the cycle window

The base case is that Belastingdienst does not publicly commit to a post-2030 European Tax Administration architecture inside the cycle window. The political conversation is not ready; the Member State unanimity hurdle remains; the operational implications are too large to be absorbed alongside the other four workstreams. Position quietly inside DG TAXUD design conversations; do not lead publicly.

Reinstatement Trigger: Hoekstra cabinet of advisors floats a feasibility study or two or more Member States table a formal position paper.

Discussion Points for Senior Leadership Consideration

1. **If the Jaarplan 2027 (December 2026) revises a 2026 modernisation completion target downward**, will Belastingdienst publicly republish its capacity-allocation framework with revised IV-day envelopes, or absorb the slippage internally?
2. **If the EU AI Act 2 August 2026 high-risk deadline arrives with one or more Belastingdienst category-B algorithms not yet compliant**, what is the pre-decided posture — temporary suspension, accelerated remediation, public retirement?
3. **If the Eerste Kamer materially amends or rejects the Wet werkelijk rendement box 3 this spring**, does Belastingdienst capacity allocated to the Box 3 transition workstream get reallocated to the Jetten reform delivery workstream, or held for the next Box 3 attempt?
4. **If the Jetten coalition fragments before the end-2026 reform agenda publication**, does Belastingdienst maintain the embedded-tax design direction unilaterally or revert to an existing-operating-model improvement track?
5. **If an AP-mandated retirement order lands on a high-operational-value Belastingdienst algorithm**, what is the Concerndirectie Toezicht's pre-decided posture — comply immediately, contest publicly, request transition window?
6. **If a soevereinen-related incident escalates to a staff-safety event**, does Belastingdienst extend the anonymity protocol to additional case categories, request additional security budget, or restructure the case-handling operating model?
7. Horizon-scan question **If a Dutch fintech, ERP vendor, or accounting-software provider publishes an embedded-tax product targeted at Dutch SME inside 12 months**, does Belastingdienst respond by partnering, regulating, or competing?
8. Horizon-scan question **If a Member State publishes a formal position paper on European Tax Administration architecture inside 12 months**, what is the Dutch ministerie van Financiën's pre-decided posture, and is Belastingdienst's view input or output of that posture?
9. Horizon-scan question **If two unrelated Dutch uitvoeringsorganisaties (e.g. UWV, SVB, RDW) report 200%+ AI-mediated bezwaar incidents inside 12 months**, does Belastingdienst lead a sector-wide response or wait for individual mandates?
10. **If the Brussels institutional-affairs envelope delivers regulatory-influence wins inside 12 months**, does Belastingdienst publicly take credit, share credit with DG TAXUD and CFE, or maintain quiet positioning to preserve future influence capacity?

Source Confidence Register

Format: Tier · Hyperlinked source · Date · Claim it supports · Flag/conflict notes. Sources flagged (*potentially dated*) are between 6–12 months old; sources flagged (*out of range — contextual only*) are past the 12-month threshold and used only for context, not as a board-level anchor.

Theme 1 — Trust recovery as the binding constraint

Tier	Source	Date	Claim Supported
Tier 1	Algemene Rekenkamer — privacy algoritmes	21 May 2025	Belastingdienst
Tier 1	SCP Burgerperspectieven 2025 Bericht 1	4 Mar 2025	Government tru
Tier 1	SCP Burgerperspectieven 2025 Bericht 3	20 Oct 2025	Most recent qua
Tier 1	AIVD Openbaar Jaarverslag 2025	23 Apr 2026	Anti-institution
Tier 1	Belastingdienst Fiscale Monitor 2024	18 Nov 2024	Overall function
Tier 1	Tweede Kamer motie 10 maart 2026 — toeslagenouders standaard documenttoegang	10 Mar 2026	Standard and a
Tier 1	AP Rapportage AI & Algoritmes Nederland — maart 2026	5 Mar 2026	AI Impact Baro
Tier 1	Belastingdienst Algoritmeregister	12 Jun 2025	Belastingdienst
Tier 1	ECLI:NL:GHARL:2026:264 — Gerechtshof Arnhem-Leeuwarden	14 Jan 2026	Court of Appea
Tier 1	Algemene Rekenkamer Verantwoordingsonderzoek 2024 Financiën	21 May 2025	Annual account

Theme 2 — AI in the tax landscape

Tier	Source	Date	Claim Supported
Tier 1	EU AI Act regulatory framework	14 Feb 2026	High-risk system deadline 2 Au
Tier 2	Kennedys Law — EU AI Act compliance timeline	25 Feb 2026	Compliant risk-management sy
Tier 2	Sumsub Annual Identity Fraud Report 2026	12 Feb 2026	Fraud shift to multi-step agenti
Tier 2	Experian Fraud Forecast 2026	22 Jan 2026	Agentic AI dominant fraud vec
Tier 2	Accountant.nl — 64% of UK businesses consult AI before accountant	5 Oct 2025	Direction of travel for first-line
Tier 2	Morgan Lewis — Heppner ruling implications	18 Mar 2026	10 Feb 2026 US ruling that Cha
Tier 2	Chambers AI 2025 — Netherlands	22 Sep 2025	AP expanding algorithmic-risk
Tier 3	Agentic AI governance under EU AI Act 2026	28 Mar 2026	Agentic AI does not map onto
Tier 1	AP standing AI & algorithmic risks page	5 Mar 2026	Three top concerns: AI in recr
Tier 2	Sardine — 7 agentic AI fraud attack types live in 2026	4 Mar 2026	Identity-farm operations; auton

Theme 3 — Cross-border fiscal harmonisation

Tier	Source	Date	Claim Supported
Tier 1	European Commission — DAC8	1 Jan 2026	DAC8 in force; effective for crypto-asset
Tier 1	Wopke Hoekstra — DG TAXUD profile	15 Apr 2026	2026 priorities: tobacco taxation, simplif
Tier 2	KPMG — Dutch 2026 Tax Plan with Pillar Two and DAC9	19 Dec 2025	Implements latest OECD Pillar Two Ad
Tier 2	KPMG — Netherlands DAC8 bill approved by lower house	10 Mar 2026	Lower house approved DAC8 transpositi
Tier 2	Accountancy Europe — Tax policy update February 2026	16 Feb 2026	Tax omnibus Q2 2026; simplification pro
Tier 2	CFE — Opinion Statement FC 1/2026 on Omnibus	20 Feb 2026	Identifies fragmentation and inconsisten
Tier 2	CFE — PAC 1/2026 on DAC Recast	25 Mar 2026	DAC1-DAC9 produced overlapping repo
Tier 2	Tax Notes — EU's Tax Strategy to Shift in 2026	2 Jan 2026	Simplification overtakes harmonisation; c
Tier 2	Grant Thornton — EU Tax Omnibus directive	12 Mar 2026	Dutch tax-practitioner reading of omnib
Tier 3	EUTA — Omnibus on Taxation position paper	18 Feb 2026	Industry coalition: uncoordinated DAC8

Theme 4 — Embedded / seamless / hyper-personalised tax meets the Jetten reform window

Tier	Source	Date	Claim Supported
Tier 1	OECD — Tax Administration 3.0: From Vision to Strategy	15 Sep 2025	Embedded-tax vision: ~60% of ad
Tier 1	OECD — Tax Administration 2025	10 Nov 2025	Comparative international benchm
Tier 2	OECD — Tech-enabled tax administration of the future	18 Jun 2025	Taxation moves from "a thing tax;
Tier 2	EY — Jetten Coalition Agreement 2026-2030	30 Jan 2026	D66-VVD-CDA minority coalition
Tier 2	KPMG — Jetten coalition tax measures analysis	4 Feb 2026	Minority government 66 seats; ref
Tier 1	Belastingdienst Jaarplan 2026	11 Dec 2025	Four MJS priorities; VanZelfGoed
Tier 2	ICT Magazine NL — Belastingdienst IT 19.3% legacy	26 Sep 2025	IT 19.3% legacy 2024 (down from
Tier 2	RTC Suite — Netherlands ViDA Peppol roadmap	25 Mar 2026	EY-prepared report 10 Mar 2026;
Tier 2	Meijburg — Wet werkelijk rendement box 3 final bill	12 Feb 2026	Lower house approved 12 Feb 2026
Tier 2	Tax Notes — Monetization of Tax Data Sparks Security Concerns	6 Jan 2025	Counter-position: embedded, real-

Conflict notes: Three principal source-conflicts in this evidence base. (i) The AI-fraud forecast convergence (Sumsb + Experian + Sardine all forecast agentic-AI surge) is partially vendor-driven; the report reads it as directionally robust but treats specific magnitudes directionally. (ii) The Tax Administration 3.0 framing (OECD) and the "monetization of tax data" counter-position (Tax Notes) frame the embedded-tax direction as opportunity-and-risk respectively; the report holds both, treating embedded-tax as the operating-model future with privacy and surveillance as design constraints rather than reasons to delay. (iii) The capacity-recovery framing in Belastingdienst's own Jaarplan 2026 ("deel ICT-systemen kan vanaf 2026 nieuw beleid aan") and the modernisation-slippage signal in ICT Magazine (two of nine projects behind schedule) are not contradictory but point in different directions; the report treats the Jaarplan framing as the published baseline and the slippage signal as a watch-item that would force scenario re-pricing. **Author-type coverage:** regulators and institutional bodies well-represented (EC, AIVD, AP, Algemene Rekenkamer, OECD, SCP); think-tanks under-represented (no CPB / WRR / Rathenau Instituut sources cited this cycle — would deepen if added); academic / peer-reviewed sources thin (no Nederlandsche Juristen-Vereniging or law-faculty research papers — to add for next cycle); investor / VC-letter authorship absent (would be relevant on the embedded-tax fintech weak signal).

End of report. Next cycle: 28 May 2026. Source set frozen at 2026-04-28. Sources flagged for replacement at next cycle: Algemene Rekenkamer privacy-algoritmes (May 2025) — boundary, replace with FY24 follow-up Verantwoordingsonderzoek when published; SCP Burgerperspectieven 2025 Bericht 1 (March 2025) — replace with Bericht 1 2026 when published; Belastingdienst Fiscale Monitor 2024 — Fiscale Monitor 2025 expected end-2026; OECD Tax Administration 3.0 strategy report (Sept 2025) — boundary; OECD blog Tech-enabled tax administration (June 2025) — boundary; Belastingdienst Algoritmeregister (June 2025) — Q3 2026 update expected; Chambers AI Netherlands 2025 — boundary, replace with 2026 edition; ICT Magazine Belastingdienst IT 19.3% (Sept 2025) — boundary, replace with Stand van de Uitvoering Q4 2026; Tax Notes Monetization of Tax Data (Jan 2025) — boundary; Algemene Rekenkamer Verantwoordingsonderzoek 2024 Financiën — boundary, FY25 examination expected May 2026; Accountant.nl 64% businesses ChatGPT (Oct 2025) — boundary.